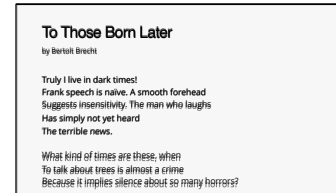


Excited, asked before Ireland trip,
green and rain-soaked thoughts



Poetry can't change world; but
changed my world therefore could
change yours

Protocols

- P₀**: protokollon, "first glued", a preface
- P₁**: behavioural guidelines for repeatable outcomes
- P₂**: communication guidelines for interoperability
- P₃**: an engineered argument, "protocolling"

Tension: a compromise plus a conflict

Crit & Craft / former first-order;
latter second-order / protocolling
– opinionated but with purpose of
inciting / poetrying, poeming and
poeting

Poetry

- "Poetry is the synthesis of typacrits and
litocrits"
-Carl Sandburg
- "Poetry is an imaginary garden with real
roads in it."
-Marjorie Moore
- "If I knew where poetry came from, I'd go
there."
-Robert Langley
- "Poetry is what happens when nothing else
can."
-Dorothy B. Brown
- "Poetry is what gets lost in translation."
-Robert Frost
- "Poetry helps us imagine what it's like to be a
human."
-Mark Strand
- "Poetry is like a drop of oil in a sea of a
million."
-John F. Kennedy
- "Poetry is the best impression of a thing in a
word."
-William S. Burroughs

notice what you notice / will be
writing etc. / poetry uses words to
transcend words



Compression algorithm / Heney
Beowulf “good king” / Lynne Kelley
Memory Code / Hertzog homo
spiritualis / “poetry uses words to
transcend words” – Bell (hear a lot;
example of true poet up close)
(Heaney’s Punishment – exact and
intimate tribal revenge)

<https://gatomonodesign.de/wordpress/mnemosynes-tango-poetry-film-and-the-dance-of-memory/>

Write

♦ One thing that is false about poetry
(multiple words, but does not have to be a sentence)

Poetrying

"Poetry uses words to get beyond words"
-Marvin Bell

Still about sequencing but
macroscopic scope of human
experience

Gestalt System

Poetry uses words to get beyond words

$$P(\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}) = \sum_i w_i$$

Gestalt System

Poetry uses words to get beyond words

$$P(\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}) > \sum_i^n w_i$$

Gestalt – greater than sum of parts

Fermi-Dyson Equations

$$P(\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}) > \sum_i^n w_i$$

$$P(\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}) > \{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}$$

$$P(r, n) = B(B(L(r-1)) \rightarrow r)$$

$$\lambda(n) = L(n-1)$$

$$P(n) = G(G(G(s_1, s_2, s_3), \dots, s_i))$$

$$\text{Asell}(d, f, w) = \text{notice}(\text{inner}(d), \text{outer}(d), f, w) \rightarrow w$$

Enrico Fermi (1901–1954) – not quant “how many piano tuners in Chicago?” w/o counting, but qual – shape of equation / protocol
Freeman Dyson – gratuitous, make mathematicians and poets chuckle alike, in that chuckle give space for degrees of freedom in thinking

Gödel Incompleteness

Poetry uses words to get beyond words

$$P(\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}) \supset \{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}$$

Kurt Gurdel - First incompleteness theorem - In any formal axiomatic system, there are truths that cannot be proven within the system

Infinite Game

∞

Solve problem at level of problem is an Unwinnable, Impossible, Important
Tension = compromise + conflict – create/reconcile – so this is the “fundamental tension” of poetry

Poetrying

"Learn the rules, break the rules, make up new rules, break the new rules." –Marvin Bell

Still about sequencing but
macroscopic scope of human
experience

Rules in Language

Lovely little old rectangular green French silver whittling knife
opinion size age shape colour origin material purpose noun

Little lovely old rectangular green French silver whittling knife
Lovely old little rectangular green French silver whittling knife
Lovely little rectangular old green French silver whittling knife
Lovely little old green rectangular French silver whittling knife
Lovely little old rectangular French green silver whittling knife
Lovely little old rectangular green silver French whittling knife
Lovely little old rectangular green French whittling silver knife

Games have rules – let's talk
about them
Intuitive grammar, language-
specific, Welsh mutations, first-
order protocols, broken for
microscopic effect

Elements of Form

metrical: rhythm/meter

structural: enjambment, caesura, stanza, sentence,
grammar/syntax

musical: rhyme, alliteration, assonance, consonance,
onomatopoeia

selective: diction, tone, connotation, specificity, imagery

ideational: metaphor, simile, allegory, rhetoric

Language-specific also, start of
conversation (ghazal, haiku, etc.),
second-order protocols,
macroscopic effect

Fundamental Algorithm

Learn the rules, break the rules.
Yes, break the new rules.

$$P(r) = S(B \ L(r) \rightarrow r_n)$$

Fundamental Algorithm

Learn the rules, break the rules,
write new rules

$$P(r) = \text{B} \text{ B}(L(r)) \rightarrow r_n$$

Fundamental Algorithm

Learn the rules, break the rules,
make up new rules, write new rules

$$P(r) = \text{B} \text{ B}(L(r)) \rightarrow r'$$

Fundamental Algorithm

Learn the rules, break the rules,
make up new rules, break the new rules

$$P(r) = B(B(L(r)) \rightarrow r')$$

Recursion

Fundamental Algorithm

Learn the rules, break the rules,
make up new rules, break the new rules

$$P(r,n) = B(B(L(r_{n-1})) \rightarrow r_n)$$

Iterative version – breaking
function as second-order protocol
/ protocolling to resolve
unresolvable tensions
(compromise + conflict) = use
words to transcend words (level of
problem)

Write

- ❖ One thing that is false about poetry
(multiple words, but does not have to be a sentence)
- ❖ One thing that has stood out to you so far
(multiple words, but does not have to be a sentence)



Disaster 1879 Tay Bridge 90 dead

-L(r): The Tay Bridge Disaster

by William McGonagall

Beautiful Railway Bridge of the Silvery Tay!
Alas! I am very sorry to say
That ninety lives have been taken away
On the last Sabbath day of 1879,
Which will be remember'd for a very long time.

...

Happens when don't learn rules

-L(r): The Tay Bridge Disaster

It must have been an awful night,
To witness in the dusky moonlight,
While the Storm-Clouds dark and angry did bray,
Along the Railway Bridge of the Silvery Tay,
O'er its head Bridge of the Silvery Tay.

I must now conclude my lay
By telling the world heartily without the least delay,
That your carter of girders would not have given any,
At days many centuries past do say,
Had you have suggested at each side with businessmen,
At days many centuries past do say,
For the strongest can not handle the load,
The iron clutches are loose of being killed.

L(r) = B(L(r)): When the World Forgets Your Name

by ChatGPT, responding to "Write one of the greatest poems of all time"

When the world forgets your name,
and time dissolves the edge of flame,
when all the maps have lost their lines
and clocks grow mute in dust and brine—

Walk still. Walk slow. Let silence speak.
There's grace in every weathered peak.
The stars do not recall their birth,
but still they sing across the earth.
...

Happens when don't break rules

L(r) = B(L(r)): When the World Forgets Your Name

Let no one's praise or scorn define
the sacred hush of your design.
A life well-lived is not a shout—
but presence, steady, burning out.

So when you fall, fall like the rain—
unheralded, but not in vain:
Each drop returns. Each root will swell.
You mattered. And the soil can tell.

Clean and open to interpretation?
/ GPT: 85–88 / The best poems by
Oliver, Hirshfield, Levertov, late
Rilke / wouldn't read as elegy to
my enemy / Davlean -0.6 / lofty
abstraction / training set = open
internet? – unlearning in MFA what
learned in poetry class

B(L(r)): Ode to My Toaster

by Chaitin G., responding to "Write one of the worst poems of all time"

Roses are blue,
Violets are the sun,
My toaster is crying,
Because bread is fun.

Crumbs of destiny fall like rain,
In my shoe I feel the pain.
Yeast is love and butter is glue,
I'm a dolphin in a sea of stew.

Bell – antidote to writers' block --
try to write a bad poem; invariably
find something interesting

B(L(r)): Ode to My Toaster

The moon is made of paper clips,
I kissed the sky—it licked my lips.
Never forget, unless you remember,
That pancakes grow in late September.

Oh toaster, fiery chrome box of fate,
You burned my soul. And also my plate.

GPT: Not lofty enough topic (35-45
/ 100) / negligible cultural impact /
“poor lyric”



DPS – rip up book preface i.e. pro-TO-kol-
lon – rules for reading; plot of importance and execution / get student to riff on
photo of Whitman – sweaty toothed madman

Write

- ❖ One thing that is false about poetry
(multiple words, but does not have to be a sentence)
- ❖ One thing that has stood out to you so far
(multiple words, but does not have to be a sentence)
- ❖ One thing that is interesting about poetry
(multiple words, but does not have to be a sentence)

Share one of the three things

The Great Flailing

$$P(r,n) = B(B(L(r_{n-1})) \rightarrow r_n)$$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} B(B(L(r_{n-1})) \rightarrow r_n) = r_{free}$$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} B(B(L(r_{n-1})) \rightarrow r_n) = \{r_{free}, r_{gross}, r_{reform}, \dots\}$$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} B(B(L(r_{n-1})) \rightarrow r_n) \neq \forall f$$

Tension drives emergence but not
finite convergence

Free verse in an evolutionary
system “local minima” but not
“global minima” (false nadir)

Theorise will never converge as a
series on negation of all rules

The Fish

by Marianne Moore

wade
through black gulls:
Of the crow-blue mussel-shells, one keeps
adjusting the ash-heaps,
opening and shutting itself like

an
ignited fan:
The barnacles which encrust the side
of the water cannot hide
there for the submerged shafts of the

The Fish

sun,
spit like spun
glass, move themselves with spotlight swiftness
into the crevices—
in and out, illuminating

the
turquoise sea
of bodies. The water drives a wedge
of iron through the iron edge
of the cliff: whereupon the stars,
—

The Fish

pink
rice grains, ink-
bespattered jelly fish, crabs like green
lilies, and submarine
toadstools, slide each on the other.

All
external
marks of abuse are present on this
defiant edifice—
all the physical features of
—

The Fish	
ac-	1
cident—lack	3
of cornice, dynamite grooves, burns, and	9
hatchet strokes, these things stand	6
out on it; the chasm-side is	8
dead.	1
Repeated	3
evidence has proved that it can live	9
on what can not revive	6
its youth: the sea grows old in it.	8

Guessed the form?

Write	
♦Count the syllables of each line of the previous three things	
♦Write three new things you have noticed so far	
♦Write them using the same syllable count pattern	
♦e.g. line 1 and 4, 2 and 5, 3 and 6 have the same syllable count	
♦Optional: rearrange the lines as you see fit	
♦Give it a title	

Share one of the new lines or whole poem in chat
congrats, now all written a poem

Poems

"The poem is a little myth of man's capacity of making life meaningful." –Robert Penn Warren

"This is my letter to the world / that never wrote to me—" =
Emily Dickinson

"Poetry is just the evidence of life. If your life is burning well,
poetry is just the ash." –Leonard Cohen

Poeming

"A poem listens to itself as it goes along." –Marvin Bell

"Out of the quarrels with others we make rhetoric; out of the
quarrels with ourselves we make poetry." –W.B. Yeats

Algorithms

A poem listens to itself as it goes along

$$\lambda(n) = L(\lambda(n-1))$$

Anthropomorphic – but also line
has quality of attending
Can be sentence if prose or dead
man, word in concrete poem, etc.
mirrors LLM generation (token
instead of line; mechanical Turk
magic convo layer fast typist)

Algorithms

out of the quarrels with ourselves we make poetry

$$P(n) = Q(Q(Q(s_1, s_2), s_3), \dots s_n)$$

$$T_n = Q(s_{n-2}, s_{n-1}), s_n$$

compromise + conflict

Head recursion, because infinite
game never resolves
Finite machine would crash, but
can capture
Single frame of call to the quarrel
function gives a representation of
tension
“poem never finished only
abandoned” Paul Valery

Write

- ❖ Choose an object in the room you are in
- ❖ Think of someone you hate
- ❖ Give that object the voice of the person and have it write a line

Write

- ❖ Choose another object in the room
- ❖ Think of someone you admire
- ❖ Give that object the voice of the person and have it write a line

Write

- ♦ Write a response to the previous two lines
- ♦ Give it a title

Share your favourite line / congrats
two poems = poet

Poet

"To be a poet was never my ambition. It was simply my way of
being alone." - Rainer Maria Rilke

"Always be a poet, even in prose." - Charles Baudelaire

"You must revise your life" - William Stafford

Poet living whitehead protocol /
operating system

Poeting

"Be a poet every day; even if you don't write something every day, be a poet every day." –Marvin Bell

"Read something, then write something, and let what you write be informed by what you read." –Marvin Bell

"Take the time to write: you can do your life's work in 40 minutes a day" –Robert Hass

Algorithm

be a poet every day (not writing)

$\Delta\text{self}(d,r) = \text{notice}(\text{inner}(d), \text{outer}(d), r)$

Algorithm

be a poet every day (writing, bootstrap)

$\Delta\text{self}(d,r) = \text{notice}(\text{inner}(d), \text{outer}(d), r) \rightarrow w$

Algorithm

be a poet every day (writing, ongoing)

$\Delta\text{self}(d,r,w) = \text{notice}(\text{inner}(d), \text{outer}(d), r, w) \rightarrow w'$

The mind dump – scroll since 2008
– returning after long period

Algorithm

be a poet; do your life's work

$\text{work} = \sum_x \text{notice}(\text{inner}(d_i), \text{outer}(d_i), r_i, w_{i-1})$

$\text{self} = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \text{notice}(\text{inner}(d_n), \text{outer}(d_n), r_n, w_{n-1})$

The mind dump – scroll since 2008
– returning after long period for
sake of self-making

Foolish Pursuit



Social implications of work
“no money in poetry / etc.” graves
Not pejorative, fool exists outside
protocols of the court therefore
can speak truth out side of mouth



Kyoami – fool in Lear via
Kurosawa's Ran, also Benshi in
kabuki / jōruri in bunraku – meta-
level narrators, omniscient
Person of infinite jest = poet



<https://www.bodyliterature.com/2014/03/04/the-poem-robert-peake-on-marvin-bells-wednesday/>

Wednesday

Gray rainwater lay on the grass in
the late afternoon.
The carp lay on the bottom,
resting, while dusk took shape

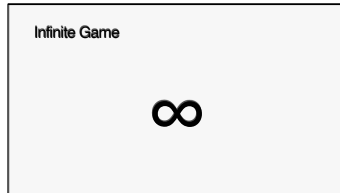
in the form of the first stirrings of
his hunger,
and the trees, shorter and heavier,
breathed heavily upward.
Into this sodden, nourishing
afternoon I emerged,
partway toward a paycheck,
halfway toward the weekend,
carrying the last mail and holding
above still puddles
the books of noble ideas. Through
the fervent branches,
carried by momentary breezes of
local origin,
the palpable Sublime flickered as
motes on broad leaves,
while the Higher Good and the
Greater Good contended

as sap on the bark of the maples,
and even I
was enabled to witness the truly
Existential where it loitered
famously in the shadows as if
waiting for the moon.
All this I saw in the late afternoon
in the company of no one.

And of course I went back to work
the next morning. Like you,
like anyone, like the rumored
angels of high office,
like the demon foremen, the
bedeviled janitors, like you,
I returned to my job--but now there
was a match-head in
my thoughts.

In its light, the morning
increasingly flamed through the
window
and, lit by nothing but mind-light, I
saw that the horizon
was an idea of the eye, gilded from
within, and the sun
the fiery consolation of our
nighttimes, coming far.
Within this expectant air, which
had waited the night indoors,
carried by--who knows?--the
rhythmic jarring of brain tissue
by footsteps, by colors visible to
closed eyes, by a music
in my head, knowledge gathered
that could not last the day,
love and error were shaken as if by

the eye of a storm,
and it would not be until quitting
that such a man
might drop his arms, that he had
held up all day since the dew.



Personal

Unwinnable, Impossible,
Important (Pre James Cause:) “No
permanence is ours; we are the
flood that flows to fit whatever
form it finds” – Magister Ludi,
Glass Bead Game / pro-TO-ko-lon
for living attentively / purpose of
life is to be defeated by greater
and greater things / live in the
question /
poetry -> poems -> poets